

WELCOME TO OUR 2ND JOINT CONFERENCE



Ann & Robert H. Lurie Children's Hospital of Chicago and Americans Against Language Barriers logos

2026 Lurie Children's & AALB Conference

True Language Access: Yesterday, Today, and Tomorrow

We are thrilled to have you in Chicago for the 2026 Lurie Children's & AALB Joint Conference!

PREP CHECKLIST

To ensure you have a seamless and rewarding experience, please review this quick checklist:

- **Dress Layered:** Bring a sweater or light jacket! Conference rooms with air conditioning can get chilly during long sessions.
- **Networking Essentials:** Bring plenty of business cards or set up a digital business card (e.g., QR code / LinkedIn) on your phone.
- **Power Up:** Bring portable chargers/power banks and charging cables for your phone, tablet, or laptop.
- **Footwear:** Wear comfortable walking shoes—Chicago is a very walkable city!
- **Map Pins:** Pin both Lurie Children's Hospital and your hotel address on Google Maps on your phone for quick navigation.
- **Elevator Pitch:** Draft a brief script/intro so you can confidently introduce yourself to peers, vendors, and speakers!
- **Personal Comfort:** Pack chapstick, necessary personal medications, and a small reusable water bottle.
- **Positive Vibe:** Bring an open mind and a positive attitude. Your vibe introduces you before you even speak!

ACCOMMODATIONS & NEIGHBORHOOD GUIDE

Favorite Nearby Hotels (Walking Distance)

- **The Chicago Hotel Collection - Magnificent Mile** (0.1 mi away)
- **Hampton Inn & Homewood Suites Magnificent Mile** (0.1 mi away)
- **Hotel Saint Clair – Magnificent Mile** (0.2 mi away)
- **Hyatt Centric Chicago Magnificent Mile** (0.2 mi away - direct indoor bridge access to Lurie)
- **Sonesta ES Suites Chicago Downtown** (0.2 mi away)

Recommended Airbnb / Vrbo Neighborhoods

If booking a vacation rental, consider these safe, accessible neighborhoods with direct transit to Streeterville:

1. **Streeterville:** Stay right next door to the venue and Lake Michigan.
2. **Gold Coast:** Charming, historic neighborhood directly north of the hospital.
3. **River North:** Energetic dining hub just west of Streeterville.
4. **Lincoln Park:** Beautiful, tree-lined residential area just a quick 10-minute CTA Red Line ride away.

LOCAL SPOTS: EAT, DRINK & EXPLORE

Favorite Places to Eat Nearby

- **Beatrix (Streeterville):** Great spot for coffee, breakfast, or healthy lunch options.
- **The Hampton Social (Streeterville):** Coastal-inspired dining perfect for group dinners.
- **Eataly Chicago:** A vibrant 2-story Italian marketplace with pasta, pizza, and espresso bars.
- **Gino's East:** Famous for authentic deep-dish pizza, graffiti-lined walls, and rich, golden crusts.
- **Starbucks Reserve Roastery:** Nearby on Michigan Avenue, this is the largest Starbucks in the world.
- **Chicago Diner:** Local "meat-free restaurant since '83," famous for its award-winning Radical Reuben sandwich.

Local Points of Interest (All within walking distance)

- **The Magnificent Mile (Michigan Ave):** World-class shopping, dining, and architecture.
- **Navy Pier & Centennial Wheel:** Iconic Chicago landmark overlooking Lake Michigan.
- **Museum of Contemporary Art (MCA):** Located directly across the street from Lurie Children's!
- **Chicago Riverwalk & Millennium Park (Cloud Gate / "The Bean"):** Scenic downtown walks a short distance south.
- **360 CHICAGO / The John Hancock Building:** Breathtaking 360-degree panoramic views of Lake Michigan and the Chicago skyline.
- **The Art Institute of Chicago:** Located a short walk south in Grant Park, home to one of the world's finest and largest collections of Impressionist and post-Impressionist art.

Our Sponsors, Partners, Exhibitors, and Supporters

Thank You to Our Partners & Sponsors! This event would not be possible without the generous support of our sponsors who share our vision for language equity and accessibility in healthcare. Visit the exhibitor tables located outside the main hall during coffee break.

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